

SKINTONES

All skin tones, from the palest to the darkest of complexions, are made up of a combination of three colors: red, yellow, and blue. Therefore, it is possible to mix all skin colors with a very

limited selection of paints: raw sienna, alizarin crimson, cerulean blue, and cadmium red. When you paint skin, remember it is reflective so will also be affected by the colors around it.



Raw sienna and alizarin crimson make a soft, even skin tone, which can be used for all skin types.



Cool down a raw sienna and alizarin crimson mix with cerulean blue to help model a face.



Raw sienna and cadmium red make a strong color suitable for tanned or dark skin.



Layering colors wet on dry creates luminous skin tones, which can be softened with water, as on the right-hand side.

Pure colors



Raw sienna



Alizarin crimson



Cerulean blue



Cadmium red

Color mixes



Raw sienna and alizarin crimson



Raw sienna and cerulean blue



Alizarin crimson and cerulean blue



Raw sienna, alizarin crimson, and cerulean blue



Alizarin crimson is used on the side of the face.

Warmer colors are used down the center of the face.

Dark tones mixed from pink, yellow, and blue look soft.

Portrait of a man This face has been painted using raw sienna, alizarin crimson, cerulean blue, and cadmium red. The colors have been built up slowly from light to dark to create a radiant face.